

When you *do* have to buy a replacement part, whether it's a new faucet, fridge, or even something as big as an air conditioner, it pays to research your options. Even though it might be tempting to buy the least expensive brand, cheap fixtures don't always last.

Read multiple reviews from a variety of sources and ask around to see what friends and family have used themselves. It's much better to pay for a replacement part that lasts ten to twenty years, than to skimp on one that lasts only two. You'll only end up paying more money in the long run.

6. **PERFORM PREVENTATIVE MAINTENANCE**

Preventative maintenance is the best way to keep outrageous repairs from taking over your home. No, you won't be able to stop every possible problem from happening, but by doing simple tasks such as changing your air conditioner and/or furnace filters often, preventing water leaks with caulk, and regularly cleaning out gutters, you will significantly reduce the chance of even bigger problems down the road.

Also, if you love to-do lists and schedules, put some of the most common maintenance items into a checklist so you can keep up on all that preventative maintenance without it slipping your mind. Staying organized is key to things getting done, and you can download a Home Maintenance Checklist at CreativeSavingsBlog.com/ExpenseResources to make sure you never forget another task.